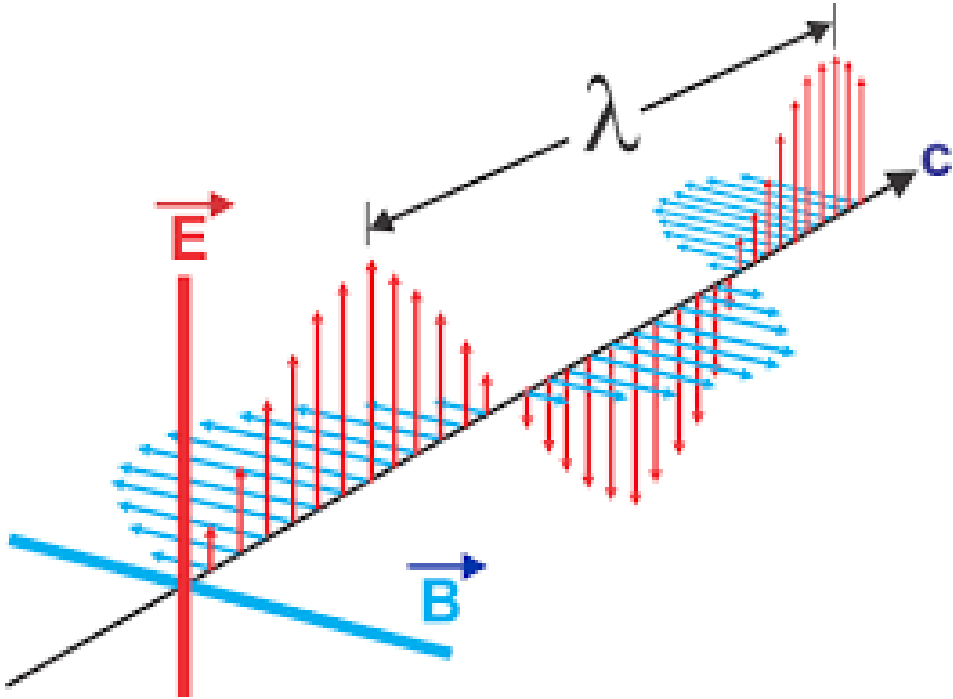


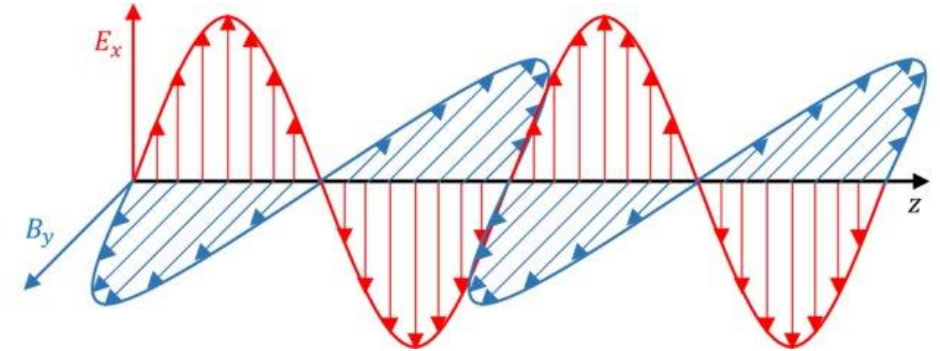
Electromagnetic Wave

Part-2



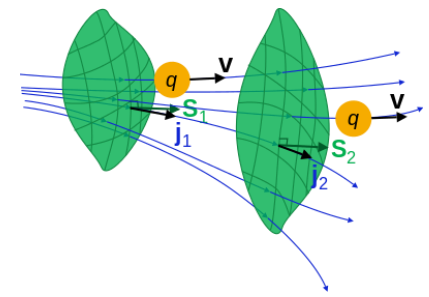
Ram Prakash
Professor
Department of Physics
Indian Institute of Technology (IIT), Jodhpur

Email: ramprakash@iitj.ac.in



Electromagnetic wave in conductor

Electromagnetic Waves in Conductors



In the case of conductors, $\vec{J}_f$ is not zero.

The current density in a conductor is proportional to the electric field.

$$\vec{J}_f = \sigma \vec{E} \quad \dots (1) \quad (\text{Ohm's law})$$

With this, Maxwell's equation for linear conducting media assume the form

$$\begin{aligned} (i) \quad \vec{\nabla} \cdot \vec{E} &= \frac{\rho_f}{\epsilon} \\ (ii) \quad \vec{\nabla} \cdot \vec{B} &= 0 \\ (iii) \quad \vec{\nabla} \times \vec{E} &= -\frac{\partial \vec{B}}{\partial t} \\ (iv) \quad \vec{\nabla} \times \vec{B} &= \mu \sigma \vec{E} + \mu \epsilon \frac{\partial \vec{E}}{\partial t} \quad \dots (2) \end{aligned}$$

$$(\text{Rate that } q \text{ is flowing through the imaginary surface } S) = \iint_S \mathbf{j} \cdot d\mathbf{S}$$

$$\frac{dq}{dt} + \iiint_V \mathbf{j} \cdot d\mathbf{S} = \Sigma$$

Σ is the net rate that q is being generated inside the volume V per unit time

The continuity equation for free charge,

$$\vec{\nabla} \cdot \vec{J}_f = -\frac{\partial \rho_f}{\partial t} \quad \dots (3)$$

Using equation (1) in (3), we get

$$\sigma(\vec{\nabla} \cdot \vec{E}) = -\frac{\partial \rho_f}{\partial t}$$

$$\text{But } \vec{\nabla} \cdot \vec{E} = \frac{\rho_f}{\epsilon}$$

$$\text{Therefore,} \quad \sigma\left(\frac{\rho_f}{\epsilon}\right) = -\frac{\partial \rho_f}{\partial t}$$

$$\text{Or,} \quad \rho_f\left(\frac{\sigma}{\epsilon}\right) + \frac{\partial \rho_f}{\partial t} = 0 \quad \dots (4)$$

$$\text{So,} \quad \rho_f(t) = \rho_f(0) e^{-(\sigma/\epsilon)t} \quad \dots (5)$$

$\Rightarrow$ Any initial free charge $\rho_f(0)$ dissipates in a characteristic time $\tau = \epsilon/\sigma$.

It means that if we put some free charge on a conductor, it will flow out to the edges.

The time constant τ is a measure of how “good” a conductor is.

- For a good conductor, τ is much less than the other relevant times in the problem (e.g., in oscillatory system, this means $\tau \ll \frac{1}{\omega}$)
- For a “poor” conductor, τ is greater than the characteristic times in the problem ($\tau \gg \frac{1}{\omega}$)

Here we are not interested in this transient behaviour, we will wait for any accumulated free charge to disappear. Then, $\overline{\rho_f} = 0$.

Then, we will have following Maxwell's equation

$$(i)\vec{\nabla} \cdot \vec{E} = 0$$

$$..... (6)$$

$$(ii)\vec{\nabla} \cdot \vec{B}=0$$

$$(iii)\vec{\nabla} \times \vec{E}=-\frac{\partial \vec{B}}{\partial t}$$

$$(iv)\vec{\nabla} \times \vec{B}=\mu\sigma\vec{E}+\mu\epsilon\frac{\partial \vec{E}}{\partial t}$$

Now, applying curl to equations (iii) and (iv):

Equation (iii) is:

$$\begin{aligned} \vec{\nabla} \times (\vec{\nabla} \times \vec{E}) &= -\frac{\partial (\vec{\nabla} \times \vec{B})}{\partial t} \\ \vec{\nabla} (\vec{\nabla} \cdot \vec{E}) - \nabla^2 \vec{E} &= -\frac{\partial}{\partial t} (\mu\sigma\vec{E}+\mu\epsilon\frac{\partial \vec{E}}{\partial t}) \\ \text{Or, } -\nabla^2 \vec{E} &= -\mu\epsilon\frac{\partial^2 \vec{E}}{\partial t^2} - \mu\sigma\frac{\partial \vec{E}}{\partial t} \\ \nabla^2 \vec{E} &= \mu\epsilon\frac{\partial^2 \vec{E}}{\partial t^2} + \mu\sigma\frac{\partial \vec{E}}{\partial t} (7) \end{aligned}$$

Equation (iv) is :

$$\begin{aligned} \vec{\nabla} \times (\vec{\nabla} \times \vec{B}) &= \mu\sigma(\vec{\nabla} \times \vec{E})+\mu\epsilon\frac{\partial (\vec{\nabla} \times \vec{E})}{\partial t} \\ \vec{\nabla} (\vec{\nabla} \cdot \vec{B}) - \nabla^2 \vec{B} &= -\mu\epsilon\frac{\partial^2 \vec{B}}{\partial t^2} - \mu\sigma\frac{\partial \vec{B}}{\partial t} \\ \nabla^2 \vec{B} &= \mu\epsilon\frac{\partial^2 \vec{B}}{\partial t^2} + \mu\sigma\frac{\partial \vec{B}}{\partial t} (8) \end{aligned}$$

Thus, we will have

$$\begin{aligned} \nabla^2 \vec{E} &= \mu\epsilon\frac{\partial^2 \vec{E}}{\partial t^2} + \mu\sigma\frac{\partial \vec{E}}{\partial t} \\ \nabla^2 \vec{B} &= \mu\epsilon\frac{\partial^2 \vec{B}}{\partial t^2} + \mu\sigma\frac{\partial \vec{B}}{\partial t} \end{aligned}$$

Note: 3D wave equations for E and B in a conductor have an additional term that has a single time derivative – which is analogous to a velocity dependent damping term associated with the motion of a 1D mechanical harmonic oscillator.

The general solutions ~in the form of an oscillatory function times a damping term (i.e., a decaying exponential) in the direction of the propagation of the EM wave.

A Complex plane wave type solution for E and B associated with such wave equations are of the general form.

$$\vec{E} = \vec{E}_0 e^{i(\tilde{K} z - \omega t)} \dots\dots\dots (9)$$

$$\vec{B} = \vec{B}_0 e^{i(\tilde{K} z - \omega t)} \dots\dots\dots (10)$$

With complex wave number

$$\tilde{K} = k + iK \dots\dots\dots (11)$$

$$\tilde{K} = \tilde{K}(\omega)$$

From Eqs. 9, 10, 7 & 8

$$\tilde{K}^2 = \mu\epsilon\omega^2 + i\mu\sigma\omega \dots\dots\dots (12)$$

Then,

$$\tilde{K}^2 = (k + iK)^2 = k^2 - K^2 + 2ikK = \mu\epsilon\omega^2 + i\mu\sigma\omega$$

$$\text{Or } [(k^2 - K^2) - \mu\epsilon\omega^2] + i[2kK - \mu\sigma\omega] = 0 \dots\dots\dots (13)$$

Only way this relation can be true, when

$$(k^2 - K^2) - \mu\epsilon\omega^2 = 0$$

$$2kK - \mu\sigma\omega = 0$$

$$(k^2 - K^2) = \mu\epsilon\omega^2 \dots\dots\dots (14)$$

$$2kK = \mu\sigma\omega \dots\dots\dots (15)$$

We need to solve equations (14) and (15) simultaneously to determine k and K.

From equation (15), we get

$$K = \frac{\mu\sigma\omega}{2k} \dots\dots\dots (16)$$

Plugging this into equation (14)

$$k^2 - K^2 = k^2 - \left(\frac{\mu\sigma\omega}{2k}\right)^2 = \mu\epsilon\omega^2$$

Multiplying above equation by k^2 , we get

$$k^4 - \left(\frac{\mu\sigma\omega}{2}\right)^2 = (\mu\epsilon\omega^2)k^2$$

$$k^4 - (\mu\epsilon\omega^2)k^2 - \left(\frac{1}{2}\mu\sigma\omega\right)^2 = 0 \dots\dots\dots (17)$$

Let's define $x = k^2$

$$a = 1$$

$$b = -(\mu\epsilon\omega^2)$$

$$c = -\left(\frac{\mu\sigma\omega}{2}\right)^2$$

Then equation (17) becomes

$$ax^2+bx+c = 0$$

$$\text{therefore, } x = \frac{-b \pm \sqrt{b^2 - 4ac}}{2a}$$

$$\text{or, } k^2 = \frac{1}{2} [(\mu\epsilon\omega^2) \pm \sqrt{(\mu\epsilon\omega^2)^2 + 4\left(\frac{\mu\sigma\omega}{2}\right)^2}]$$

$$\text{or, } k^2 = \frac{1}{2} (\mu\epsilon\omega^2) \left[1 \pm \sqrt{1 + 4 \frac{\mu^2 \sigma^2 \omega^2}{4 \mu^2 \epsilon^2 \omega^4}} \right],$$

$$\text{or, } k^2 = \frac{1}{2} (\mu\epsilon\omega^2) \left[1 \pm \sqrt{1 + \frac{\sigma^2}{\epsilon^2 \omega^2}} \right]$$

$$\text{or, } k^2 = \frac{1}{2} (\mu\epsilon\omega^2) \left[1 \pm \sqrt{1 + \left(\frac{\sigma}{\epsilon\omega}\right)^2} \right] \dots\dots\dots (18)$$

on physical grounds, ($k^2 > 0$), we must select the +ve sign .

hence,

$$k^2 = \frac{1}{2} (\mu\epsilon\omega^2) \left[1 + \sqrt{1 + \left(\frac{\sigma}{\epsilon\omega}\right)^2} \right] \dots\dots\dots (19)$$

$$\text{or } k = \sqrt{k^2} = \omega \sqrt{\frac{\mu\epsilon}{2}} \sqrt{\left[1 + \sqrt{1 + \left(\frac{\sigma}{\epsilon\omega}\right)^2} \right]}$$

$$\text{or } k = \omega \sqrt{\frac{\mu\epsilon}{2}} \sqrt{\left[1 + \sqrt{1 + \left(\frac{\sigma}{\epsilon\omega}\right)^2} \right]} \dots\dots\dots (20)$$

having thus solved for k , we can use either of our original two relations to solve for K . for e.g. $k^2 - K^2 = \mu\epsilon\omega^2$,

$$K^2 = k^2 - \mu\epsilon\omega^2 = \frac{1}{2} (\mu\epsilon\omega^2) \left[1 + \sqrt{1 + \left(\frac{\sigma}{\epsilon\omega}\right)^2} \right] - \mu\epsilon\omega^2$$

$$\text{Or, } K^2 = \frac{1}{2} (\mu\epsilon\omega^2) \left[-1 + \sqrt{1 + \left(\frac{\sigma}{\epsilon\omega}\right)^2} \right] \dots\dots\dots (21)$$

We thus have

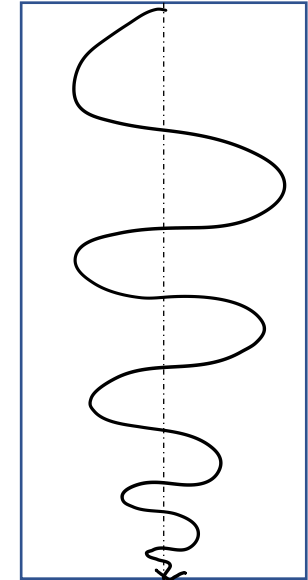
$$k = \omega \sqrt{\frac{\mu\epsilon}{2}} \sqrt{\left[1 + \sqrt{1 + \left(\frac{\sigma}{\epsilon\omega}\right)^2} \right]}$$

$$K = \omega \sqrt{\frac{\mu\epsilon}{2}} \sqrt{\left[-1 + \sqrt{1 + \left(\frac{\sigma}{\epsilon\omega}\right)^2} \right]}$$

The imaginary part of $\tilde{K}$ results in an attenuation of the wave (decreasing amplitude with increasing z)

$$\vec{\tilde{E}}(z, t) = \vec{\tilde{E}}_0 e^{-Kz} e^{i(kz - \omega t)} \dots\dots\dots (23)$$

$$\vec{\tilde{B}}(z, t) = \vec{\tilde{B}}_0 e^{-Kz} e^{i(kz - \omega t)}$$



Skin depth: The distance it takes to reduce the amplitude by a factor of $1/e$

$$d = \frac{1}{K} \dots\dots\dots (24) \text{ where } d \text{ is the skin depth.}$$

It is a measure of how far the wave penetrates into the conductor. Meanwhile the real part of $\tilde{K}$ determines the wavelength the propagation speed, and the index of reflection,

$$\lambda = \frac{2\pi}{k} \dots\dots\dots (25), \quad v = \frac{\omega}{k} \dots\dots\dots (26), \quad n = \frac{ck}{\omega} \dots\dots\dots (27)$$

Maxwell's equation (6) impose further constraints fixes relatives amplitudes, phases and polarizations of E and B.

Eq. 6(i) and (ii) rule out any z components: the fields are transverse.

Assuming E is polarized along the x- direction:

$$\vec{E}(z, t) = \tilde{E}o e^{-Kz} e^{i(kz - \omega t)} \hat{x} \dots\dots\dots (28)$$

Then equation 6(iii) gives,

$$\vec{B}(z, t) = \frac{\tilde{K}}{\omega} \tilde{E}o e^{-Kz} e^{i(kz - \omega t)} \hat{y} \dots\dots\dots (29)$$

⇒ E and B Fields are mutually perpendicular.

$$\text{Since } B_y = \frac{k}{\omega} E_x$$

$$\text{where } K = |\tilde{K}| = \sqrt{K^2 + k^2} = \omega \sqrt{\mu\epsilon \sqrt{1 + \left(\frac{\sigma}{\epsilon\omega}\right)^2}} \dots\dots\dots (30)$$

$$\text{And } \phi = \tan^{-1} \frac{K}{k} \dots\dots\dots (31)$$

$\tilde{K}$ can be expressed in terms of its modulus and phase:

$$\tilde{K} = k e^{i\phi}$$

According to equation (28) and (29), the complex amplitude

$\tilde{E}o = Eo e^{i\delta_E}$ and $\tilde{B}o = Bo e^{i\delta_B}$ (free space case) are related here by

$$Bo e^{i\delta_B} = \frac{ke^{i\phi}}{\omega} Eo e^{i\delta_E} \dots\dots\dots (32)$$

Thus, it is evident that the electric and magnetic fields are no longer in phase. In fact,

$\delta_B - \delta_E = \phi$ implies that magnetic field lags behind the electric field.

The real amplitudes of $\vec{E}$ and $\vec{B}$ are related by

$$\frac{Eo}{Bo} = \frac{k}{\omega} = \sqrt{\mu\epsilon \sqrt{1 + \left(\frac{\sigma}{\epsilon\omega}\right)^2}} \dots\dots\dots (34)$$

Thanks